

PHOTO BY **HARDIK CHHABRA**

“It has four big heart-shaped diamonds, and it took me five-six years to collect them. They reflect my husband, my two sons, and myself,” says the 45-year-old, who has an exceptional collection of jewellery, including an anklet by US-based luxury jewellery brand Harry Winston, a 20-carat heart-shaped diamond ring, and a cluster of Colombian emeralds that she has been collecting over the past few years.

Her Met Gala necklace was designed by ace designer Farah Khan Ali, who says Reddy takes a keen interest in the design of her clothes and jewellery. That’s probably because of her degree from the National Institute of Fashion Design.

Radhikaraje Gaekwad of the erstwhile princely state of Baroda agrees with Reddy when she says, “The authenticity of being myself is the greatest luxury, today when I am in my 40s.” She adds that it may have meant material things when she was younger. Known for her passion for the arts and crafts of India, Gaekwad heads the museum that exhibits the family’s collection of 45 Raja Ravi Varma paintings, amongst other things. “My favourite is the Lakshmi and the painting of Chinnabai II on a crystal chair in a black saree,” she says.

“My greatest possessions are the saris that I have inherited from my grandmother and grandmother-in-law: pure silks and cotton saris with real gold zari. I feel privileged to have access to hand-me-downs, whether they are old bags or shoes. Naturally some of them are frayed or stained, but legacy doesn’t come unblemished. I carry them with pride. After all, these things have outlived generations,” she smiles.

For Gautam Singhania, the Chairman and MD of the Raymond group, luxury is that “in which you do not indulge in regularly,” but at the same time it means different things to different people. “For me, taking a chopper three times a week to go to work is a necessity, but for you, it may be a luxury,” he says.